Monday, July 3

Terror attack in Tel Aviv. Some eight people wounded, several of them severely. The assailant was a Palestinian working illegally in the country, declared that it was to avenge Jenin. He was killed. Hamas declared that the attack was to avenge Jenin.

The operation in Jenin is drawing to a close. One soldier killed at the last moment. Netanyahu declared that such an incursion will be repeated in the future, as often as necessary. Twelve Palestinians were killed. According to CNN, the damage done to the infrastructure is considerable, but, as I wrote and as many others say, will it change anything in the longer run? Most commentators doubt it. Someone dubbed it Acamol (acetaminophen) administered to a terminally ill patient.

Such operations make me wonder each time anew how many Israelis carry this semi-conscious wish to control the whole of Eretz Israel. While the fight for democracy is that of a majority, I am not sure whether the one for a gradual two-state solution would get the support of the same proportion of the population. That, in my opinion, is our basic problem. International pressure will maintain the status quo for some time, but it is most doubtful that it can achieve more.

Regarding the fight against the judicial overhaul, I fear that the opposition won’t succeed without major civil disobedience, as has been strongly advocated by the former prime minister and chief of staff Ehud Barak, today head of a small left-wing party. At least it is being publicly aired. Reserve officers’ refusal to report for duty is a manifestation of that intention.

This was total anathema in my time. When Begin’s government made noises about annexing the West Bank, I stated on Abba Ahimeir’s political news program that were this to transpire I would refuse to report for reserve duty. The reaction was immediate: Ahimeir didn’t speak to me for the rest of the discussion, nor did the three other participants. My phone remained